

Indium

49
In

When electricity is passed through indium atoms they glow an indigo colour, which is where the metal gets its name from.

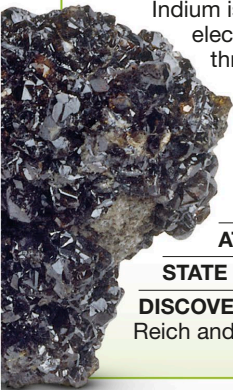
Indium is used to make very thin electrical wires that run through the touchscreens of mobile phones.

Black crystals of sphalerite, an ore of indium

ATOMIC MASS 114.818

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1863 (Ferdinand Reich and Hieronymus Richter)



Nihonium

113
Nh

This is the only artificial element made in Japan. It was named after the Japanese name for Japan, “Nihon”. Nihonium forms when moscovium atoms break apart, but it can also be made by smashing bismuth and zinc atoms together. It is highly radioactive, and is used only in research.

ATOMIC MASS (286)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 2004 (team led by Kosuke Morita)

Thallium

81
Tl

This soft metal takes its name from the Greek word “thallos”, which means “green shoot or twig”, because it burns with a bright green flame. Pure thallium is very toxic: if ingested, it causes stomach pains and makes hair fall out.

ATOMIC MASS 204.38

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1861 (William Crookes)

Laboratory sample of pure thallium in an airless vial

Pure thallium is stored away from air to keep it from tarnishing.

